# Design elements & principles

Higher · Design & DTP · Worksheet

GRAPHICS WITH MR KELLY

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

**By the end of this worksheet I can…**

- ☐ explain line, colour, alignment, contrast, dominance, depth and unity, referring to specific items
- ☐ name the type of alignment between items
- ☐ explain shape, texture, value, mass, balance, emphasis, proportion, rhythm, white space and grid structure
- ☐ answer "explain" questions with cause and effect

## I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

*A poster for a smartwatch has a large white "65%" over a black background and a "BUY NOW" button in the same white.*

**1 Explain how two design elements or principles have been used to create visual impact.** (2 marks)

**Full-mark answer** each ✓ is one mark

The white "65%" contrasts strongly with the black background, so it stands out ✓. It is also the largest element on the poster, so it dominates and is the first thing the viewer reads ✓.

**Why marks are not awarded**

*"Contrast and dominance have been used to make it stand out."*

0 marks: no items in the poster are referred to.

## WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

*A web page has a heading, a block of body text and three images down the right-hand side.*

**2 Describe two examples of alignment used in the layout.** (2 marks)

**Sentence starters**

One … is …, which means …

Another … is …, so …

**Word bank**

heading · captions · centrally · bottom · vertically · images · aligned

Tip: 2 marks = 2 separate, developed points.

**YOU DO** **On your own** No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

### 3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

**a)** Which has a HIGH value?
☐ Navy blue ☐ Dark green ☐ Black ☐ Pale pink

**b)** "Explain" questions need...
☐ A list of terms ☐ Cause and effect ☐ One word ☐ A sketch only

**c)** Numbered steps with the same formatting leading the eye show...
☐ Rhythm ☐ Balance ☐ Texture ☐ Mass

**d)** Which answer would score for alignment?
☐ The items are all aligned to look neat ☐ Alignment has been used to make it tidy ☐ Everything is balanced across the page ☐ The heading and body text are left aligned

### 4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1. **Dominance** | ____ | **A** Differences in colour, size, shape or weight that make items stand out. |
| 2. **Contrast** | ____ | **B** Items appear to be in front of others: layering, overlap, drop shadow. |
| 3. **Unity** | ____ | **C** Items look like they belong together: repeated colour, font, shape. |
| 4. **Depth** | ____ | **D** The item that stands out most and is seen first. |
| 5. **Alignment** | ____ | **E** Items lined up; always name the type: left, right, centre, top, bottom. |
| 6. **Value** | ____ | **F** Lightness or darkness: high value has more white, low value less white. |

*A kitchen brochure page has a yellow and grey frame around the main photo, a bold yellow "MODERNISE" and a white space around the company name.*

### 5 Explain how emphasis has been created in the layout. (2 marks)

*The same brochure uses pale yellow backgrounds, dark grey subheadings and a light grey body text.*

**6 Explain how value has been used in the layout.** (2 marks)

*A dog-rescue leaflet repeats white paw prints along an orange band at the top of every page, and the FAQ section alternates blue and orange rows.*

**7 Describe two examples of rhythm in the leaflet.** (2 marks)

**Check and reflect**

Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?